

THE ABERDARE TECHNICAL COLLEGE

LEARNING PLAN – COMPUTER ESSENTIALS

1. INSTITUTIONAL DETAILS

Item	Details
Module	Module 1
Unit of Competence	Computer Essentials
Unit Code	IT/CU/ICTA/CR/01/4/MA
Trainer	JAMES NDIRANGU
Competence Level	Level 5
Institution	THE ABERDARE TECHNICAL COLLEGE
Number of Learners	1

Date of Preparation	04/09/2026
Duration	12 Weeks
Training Approach	Demonstration, discussion, guided practice, individual practical exercises and assessment

SKILL OR JOB TASK

managing computer devices, managing desktop settings, performing file management, managing computer software and performing online jobs.

2. BENCHMARK OR CRITERIA TO BE USED

1. Manage computer devices

1.1 Computer Hardware devices are selected as per user requirement.

1.2 Computer Hardware devices are disassembled as per user requirement.

1.3 Computer Hardware devices are assembled as per user requirement.

1.4 Computer booting process is performed as per Unified Extensible Firmware Interface (UEFI) standards.

1.5 Computer Peripheral devices are connected as per user manual.

2. Manage desktop settings

2.1 Desktop icons are customized as per user manual.

2.2 Desktop date and time are set as per user manual.

2.3 Desktop configuration settings are performed as per user manual.

3. Perform file management

3.1 Files and folders are created per work specifications

3.2 Files and folders are transferred between various media as per user requirements

3.3 File protection is performed as per work specifications

4. Manage computer software

4.1 Data backup media is selected as per work requirements.

4.2 Data backup is performed as per work requirements

4.3 Computer software is installed as per work requirements

4.4 Computer software is optimized as per software standards

5. Perform online jobs

5.1 Online job platforms are identified as per the job requirements.

5.2 Online accounts and profiles are created in accordance with the work requirements.

5.3 Online jobs are identified according to the bidder's skillset.

5.4 Online digital identity is managed according to industry best practices.

5.5 Online job bidding is done as per the specific job requirements.

5.6 Online tasks are executed according to the job requirements.

5.7 Personal online payment account is managed in accordance with financial regulations.

MAIN LEARNING OUTCOME 1: MANAGE COMPUTER DEVICES

WEEK 1

Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
1	Manage comput	Introduction to Computer	By the end of this session, the	1. Trainer explains the meaning of	1. Trainee defines computer hardware devices.	Computer,	Oral questions,	_____

	er devices	Hardware Devices	trainees should be able to: 1. Define computer hardware devices. 2. Identify common computer components. 3. Identify common computer ports. 4. Differentiate	computer hardware devices. 2. Trainer displays different computer components. 3. Trainer demonstrates common computer ports. 4. Trainer asks the trainee to differentiate hardware devices	2. Trainee identifies the displayed computer components. 3. Trainee identifies common computer ports. 4. Trainee differentiates hardware devices according to their functions.	system unit, hardware components,	identification and observation	
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			computer hardware devices according to their functions.	according to their functions.		projector		
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
1	Manage computer devices	Computer Case and Internal Components	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Identify external computer components. 2. Locate major component s inside a	1. Trainer displays and identifies external computer components. 2. Trainer opens a system unit and demonstrates internal components. 3. Trainer	1. Trainee identifies external computer components. 2. Trainee locates internal computer components. 3. Trainee describes the functions of the motherboard, hard disk drive	System unit, monitor, keyboard, mouse, motherboard, HDD/SSD, video card	Practical identification and oral questions	

			computer case. 3. Describe the functions of the motherboard, hard disk drive and video card. 4. Classify computer hardware devices according to their functions.	explains the functions of the motherboard, hard disk drive and video card. 4. Trainer demonstrates classification of computer hardware devices.	and video card. 4. Trainee classifies hardware devices according to their functions.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
2	Manage computer devices	Disassembling Computer Hardware Devices	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Identify tools used in	1. Trainer identifies tools used for disassembly. 2. Trainer explains safety precautions. 3.	1. Trainee identifies the required tools. 2. Trainee explains the safety precautions. 3. Trainee demonstrates safe	Screwdriver set, ESD wrist strap, system unit, workbench	Observation checklist and practical task	_____

			computer disassembly. 2. Explain safety precautions during disassembly. 3. Demonstrate safe handling of computer components. 4. Disassemble a	Trainer demonstrates safe handling of components. 4. Trainer demonstrates systematic computer disassembly.	handling of components. 4. Trainee disassembles the computer systematically.			
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			computer systematic ally.					
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
2	Manage computer devices	Cleaning Computer Devices	By the end of this session, the trainees	1. Trainer identifies cleaning tools and materials. 2. Trainer	1. Trainee identifies cleaning tools and materials. 2. Trainee explains	Soft cloth, cleaning brush, compressed air, ESD equipment	Practical cleaning exercise	_____

			should be able to: 1. Identify computer cleaning tools and materials . 2. Explain the effects of dust and dirt on computer components. 3. Select	explains effects of dust and dirt. 3. Trainer demonstrates selection of suitable cleaning methods. 4. Trainer demonstrates safe cleaning procedures.	effects of dust and dirt. 3. Trainee selects appropriate cleaning methods. 4. Trainee demonstrates safe cleaning procedures.			
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			appropri ate cleaning methods. 4. Demonst rate safe cleaning of computer devices.					
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
3	Manage computer devices	Assembling Computer Hardware Devices	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Identify	1. Trainer identifies hardware devices required for assembly . 2. Trainer	1. Trainee identifies the required hardware devices. 2. Trainee explains their functions. 3. Trainee arranges components in the correct sequence. 4. Trainee assembles the computer safely.	System unit, motherboard, RAM, storage device, PSU, screwdriver set	Practical assembly and observation	_____

			hardware devices required for computer assembly. 2. Explain the functions of major hardware devices. 3.	explains their functions. 3. Trainer demonstrates the correct assembly sequence. 4. Trainer demonstrates safe computer assembly.				
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			Arrange components in the correct assembly sequence. 4. Assemble computer hardware devices safely.					
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
3	Manage computer devices	Connecting Computer Hardware Devices	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Identify computer connection ports. 2. Explain correct hardware connection	1. Trainer identifies hardware connection ports. 2. Trainer explains correct connection procedures. 3. Trainer demonstrates connecting	1. Trainee identifies hardware connection ports. 2. Trainee explains correct connection procedures. 3. Trainee connects the monitor,	Computer, monitor, keyboard, mouse, cables	Practical connection task	_____

			procedures. 3. Connect the monitor, system unit, keyboard and mouse. 4. Evaluate hardware connections for correctness and safety.	the monitor, system unit, keyboard and mouse. 4. Trainer demonstrates how to check connections.	system unit, keyboard and mouse. 4. Trainee evaluates the connections for correctness and safety.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
4	Manage computer devices	Computer Booting	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Define computer booting.	1. Trainer explains computer booting. 2. Trainer demonstrates the difference	1. Trainee defines computer booting. 2. Trainee differentiates cold and warm	Computer, system unit, monitor	Practical demonstration	_____

			2. Differentiate cold booting from warm booting. 3. Demonstrate cold booting. 4. Demonstrate warm booting.	between cold and warm booting. 3. Trainer demonstrates cold booting. 4. Trainer demonstrates warm booting.	booting. 3. Trainee performs cold booting. 4. Trainee performs warm booting.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
4	Manage computer devices	Connecting and Configuring Peripheral Devices	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Identify common peripheral devices. 2. Explain the	1. Trainer identifies printers, speakers, mouse, keyboard and projector. 2. Trainer explains the functions of the devices. 3. Trainer demonstrates	1. Trainee identifies the peripheral devices. 2. Trainee explains their functions. 3. Trainee connects the peripheral	Computer, printer, speaker, projector, keyboard, mouse	CAT 1 / Practical assessment	

			functions of peripheral devices. 3. Connect peripheral devices to a computer. 4. Configure connected peripheral devices.	connecting peripheral devices. 4. Trainer demonstrates peripheral configuration.	devices. 4. Trainee configures the connected devices.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
5	Manage desktop settings	Desktop Icons and Date/Time Settings	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Identify desktop icons and settings. 2. Explain the	1. Trainer identifies desktop icons and settings. 2. Trainer explains their purposes. 3. Trainer demonstrates desktop icon customization. 4. Trainer demonstrates	1. Trainee identifies desktop icons and settings. 2. Trainee explains their purposes. 3. Trainee customizes desktop icons. 4.	Computer, Windows operating system	Practical desktop customization	_____

			purpose of desktop icons. 3. Customize desktop icons. 4. Configure date and time settings.	date and time configuration.	Trainee configures date and time.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
5	Manage desktop settings	Desktop Background and Themes	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Identify desktop appearance settings. 2. Explain the purpose of desktop	1. Trainer identifies desktop appearance settings. 2. Trainer explains backgrounds and themes. 3. Trainer demonstrates changing background	1. Trainee identifies desktop appearance settings. 2. Trainee explains backgrounds and themes. 3. Trainee changes background colour and	Computer, Windows operating system	Practical observation	_____

			backgrounds and themes. 3. Apply appropriate background settings. 4. Customize desktop themes.	colour and pictures. 4. Trainer demonstrates application of themes.	pictures. 4. Trainee applies appropriate themes.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
6	Manage desktop settings	Taskbar, Menu Bar and Text Size	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Identify taskbar and menu bar settings. 2. Explain their	1. Trainer identifies taskbar and menu bar features. 2. Trainer explains their functions. 3. Trainer demonstrates customization.	1. Trainee identifies taskbar and menu bar features. 2. Trainee explains their functions. 3. Trainee customizes the taskbar	Computer, Windows operating system	Practical exercise	

			functions. 3. Customize taskbar and menu bar settings. 4. Adjust text size according to user requirements.	4. Trainer demonstrates text size adjustment.	and menu bar. 4. Trainee adjusts text size according to requirements.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
6	Manage desktop settings	Screen Brightness and Integrated Desktop Customization	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Identify screen brightness settings. 2. Explain the importance of suitable	1. Trainer identifies brightness settings. 2. Trainer explains suitable screen brightness. 3. Trainer demonstrates brightness adjustment.	1. Trainee identifies brightness settings. 2. Trainee explains the importance of suitable brightness. 3. Trainee adjusts screen	Computer, Windows operating system	CAT 2 / Practical assessment	

			brightness. 3. Adjust screen brightness. 4. Evaluate desktop settings against user requirements.	4. Trainer provides a desktop customization scenario for evaluation.	brightness. 4. Trainee evaluates desktop settings according to the scenario.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
7	Perform file management	Creating Files and Folders	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Define computer files and folders. 2. Differentiate between files and folders. 3. Create files and	1. Trainer explains computer files and folders. 2. Trainer demonstrates the difference between files and folders. 3. Trainer demonstrates file and	1. Trainee defines files and folders. 2. Trainee differentiates files from folders. 3. Trainee creates files and folders. 4. Trainee organizes files into appropriate folders.	Computer, File Explorer, storage device	Practical file management	

			folders. 4. Organize files into appropriate folders.	folder creation. 4. Trainer demonstrates logical file organization.				
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
7	Perform file management	File Compression, Extraction and Transfer	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Explain file compression. 2. Identify common compressed file formats. 3. Compress	1. Trainer explains file compression. 2. Trainer identifies common compressed file formats. 3. Trainer demonstrates compression and extraction. 4.	1. Trainee explains file compression. 2. Trainee identifies compressed file formats. 3. Trainee compresses and extracts files and folders. 4. Trainee	Computer, flash disk, compression utility	Practical exercise	_____

			and extract files and folders. 4. Transfer files between storage locations.	Trainer demonstrates file transfer procedures.	transfers files between storage locations.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
8	Perform file management	Sharing Files and Folders	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Identify file and folder sharing methods. 2. Explain the importance	1. Trainer identifies file-sharing methods. 2. Trainer explains the importance of file sharing. 3. Trainer demonstrates file and folder sharing. 4. Trainer	1. Trainee identifies file-sharing methods. 2. Trainee explains the importance of file sharing. 3. Trainee shares files and folders using	Computer, network, flash disk, cloud storage	Practical sharing task	

			of file sharing. 3. Share files and folders using appropriate methods. 4. Apply safe file-sharing practices.	explains safe file-sharing practices.	appropriate methods. 4. Trainee applies safe file-sharing practices.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
8	Perform file management	File Protection Using Passwords and Encryption	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Explain file protection. 2. Differentiate password protection from encryption. 3. Apply password	1. Trainer explains file protection. 2. Trainer differentiates passwords and encryption. 3. Trainer demonstrates password protection. 4. Trainer demonstrates encryption	1. Trainee explains file protection. 2. Trainee differentiates passwords and encryption. 3. Trainee applies password protection. 4. Trainee applies appropriate	Computer , password tools, encryption tools	Practical security exercise	

			protection to files. 4. Apply appropriate encryption methods. 5. Evaluate file protection methods for given situations.	procedures. 5. Trainer provides security scenarios for evaluation.	encryption. 5. Trainee evaluates protection methods for the given situations.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
9	Manage computer software	Data Backup Media and Backup Procedures	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Identify different data backup media. 2. Explain the importance of data backup. 3. Compare	1. Trainer identifies different backup media. 2. Trainer explains the importance of backup. 3. Trainer compares different backup media. 4. Trainer	1. Trainee identifies different backup media. 2. Trainee explains the importance of backup. 3. Trainee compares backup media. 4. Trainee	Flash disk, external hard drive, cloud storage, computer	Practical backup exercise	

			different backup media. 4. Select appropriate backup media for given requirements. 5. Perform data backup.	presents scenarios and guides media selection. 5. Trainer demonstrates data backup.	selects appropriate media for the scenarios. 5. Trainee performs data backup.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
9	Manage computer software	Introduction and Types of Computer Software	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Define computer software. 2. Identify types of computer software. 3. Differentiate application	1. Trainer defines computer software. 2. Trainer identifies the major software categories. 3. Trainer explains the differences between applications, operating	1. Trainee defines computer software. 2. Trainee identifies software categories. 3. Trainee differentiates applications, operating systems and utilities. 4. Trainee	Computer, Windows OS, application software, utility programs	Oral questions and practical identification	

			software, operating systems and utility programs. 4. Select appropriate software for given tasks.	systems and utilities. 4. Trainer provides user requirements and guides software selection.	selects appropriate software for the given tasks.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
10	Manage computer software	Software Installation and Configuration	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Identify software installation requirements. 2. Explain the software installation process. 3. Install	1. Trainer identifies software installation requirements. 2. Trainer explains the installation process. 3. Trainer demonstrates software installation. 4. Trainer demonstrates	1. Trainee identifies software installation requirements. 2. Trainee explains the installation process. 3. Trainee installs the required software. 4. Trainee configures	Computer, software installers, internet	Practical installation exercise	

			computer software. 4. Configure installed software according to user requirements.	software configuration.	the software according to requirements.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
10	Manage computer software	Software Optimization and Disk Cleanup	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Explain software optimization. 2. Identify software update options. 3. Update computer	1. Trainer explains software optimization. 2. Trainer identifies software update options. 3. Trainer demonstrates software updating. 4. Trainer demonstrates	1. Trainee explains software optimization. 2. Trainee identifies update options. 3. Trainee updates computer software. 4. Trainee performs disk cleanup.	Computer, operating system, internet, disk cleanup utility	CAT 3 / Practical assessment	

			software. 4. Perform computer disk cleanup. 5. Evaluate computer performance after optimization.	disk cleanup. 5. Trainer guides the trainee in evaluating system performance.	5. Trainee evaluates computer performance after optimization.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
11	Perform online jobs	Introduction to Online Working and Job Platforms	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Define online working. 2. Identify different types of online jobs. 3.	1. Trainer explains online working. 2. Trainer identifies types of online jobs. 3. Trainer introduces Upwork, Freelancer and Fiverr. 4. Trainer guides	1. Trainee defines online working. 2. Trainee identifies types of online jobs. 3. Trainee describes the major online job platforms. 4. Trainee	Computer, internet, projector, job platforms	Oral questions and platform comparison	

			Describe major online job platforms. 4. Compare online job platforms. 5. Select an appropriate platform for a given job.	comparison of the platforms. 5. Trainer provides scenarios for selecting appropriate platforms.	compares the platforms. 5. Trainee selects an appropriate platform for each scenario.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
11	Perform online jobs	Online Accounts, Profiles and Digital Identity	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Explain online account and profile management. 2. Create a professional online profile. 3.	1. Trainer explains online account and profile management. 2. Trainer demonstrates creation of a professional profile. 3. Trainer demonstrates identification of suitable	1. Trainee explains online account and profile management. 2. Trainee creates a professional online profile. 3. Trainee identifies suitable online jobs.	Computer, internet, sample profiles, job platforms	Profile creation and evaluation	

			Identify suitable online job opportunities. 4. Explain the importance of online digital identity. 5. Evaluate an online profile against professional requirements.	online jobs. 4. Trainer explains digital identity and professional online conduct. 5. Trainer provides a sample profile for evaluation.	4. Trainee explains the importance of digital identity. 5. Trainee evaluates the sample profile.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
12	Perform online jobs	Online Job Bidding and Task Execution	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Identify requirements of an online job advertisement. 2. Analyse an online job before bidding. 3. Prepare an	1. Trainer demonstrates how to read an online job advertisement. 2. Trainer guides analysis of job requirements. 3. Trainer demonstrates preparation of a professional proposal. 4. Trainer	1. Trainee identifies requirements in the job advertisement. 2. Trainee analyses the job requirements. 3. Trainee prepares a professional job proposal. 4. Trainee submits a	Computer, internet, sample job advertisements, online job platforms	Practical online job bidding	

			appropriate job proposal. 4. Submit an online job bid. 5. Execute an online task according to client requirements.	demonstrates the online bidding process. 5. Trainer provides a simulated online task.	simulated job bid. 5. Trainee executes the assigned online task according to requirements.			
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Week	Main Learning Outcome	Session Title / Subtopics	Learning Outcome	Trainer Activities	Trainee Activities	Resources	Assessment	Reflections and Dates
12	Perform online jobs	Online Payment Accounts and Integrated Computer Essentials Practical	By the end of this session, the trainees should be able to: 1. Identify online payment account concepts. 2. Explain safe online payment practices. 3.	1. Trainer explains online payment account management and security. 2. Trainer demonstrates safe online payment practices using a simulated environment.	1. Trainee identifies online payment account concepts. 2. Trainee explains safe online payment practices. 3. Trainee applies account security	Computer, internet, simulated payment environment, hardware devices, software, storage media	Final Integrated Practical Assessment	

			Apply appropriate security practices when managing online payment accounts. 4. Demonstrate integrated computer essentials skills. 5. Evaluate completed tasks against	3. Trainer guides the trainee in applying account security practices. 4. Trainer provides an integrated practical assessment. 5. Trainer guides the trainee in evaluating completed	practices in the simulation. 4. Trainee demonstrates integrated computer essentials skills. 5. Trainee evaluates completed tasks against workplace requirements.			
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			workplace requirements.	tasks against requirements.				
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